



Investment Requirement & Cost Breakdown

18-month capital plan covering one-time setup, annual renewals, monthly operating costs, and a transparent accounting of what falls outside this budget.

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All figures in Indian Rupees (Rs.). USD conversions use USD 1 = Rs. 95 for the foreign-billed line items (Apple Developer Program, Windows code-signing). Conversion drift of plus or minus 5 percent is within the rounding tolerance of this document.

1. Headline Numbers

Procta requires capital across three buckets: one-time setup (hardware, tools, prepaid hosting), annual recurring (developer program renewals), and monthly operating costs. The 18-month ask is presented in two scenarios so the reader can match the number to the level of go-to-market activity being funded.

Scenario	18-month capital requirement
A. Lean — current burn, no marketing spend live	Rs.2,65,900
B. Ramped — production email + Vercel Pro + Rs. 10,000 / mo marketing	Rs.4,81,900

Recommended pitch number: **Rs.4,81,900 (approximately Rs. 4.8 lakh)** for the 18-month ramped sprint with a real paid acquisition channel running. The lean figure Rs.2,65,900 represents the operating minimum that keeps the platform live without marketing spend. Both figures are higher than an earlier version of this document because two previously-missing costs are now included: Private Limited incorporation (a precondition of accepting this round at all) and a corrected Windows code-signing line (the original Azure Trusted Signing path turned out not to be available to us — see Section 2).

2. One-Time Setup

Items paid once at the start of the 18-month plan. Hosting and domain are prepaid two years so neither expires inside the planning window. Two items are new versus the prior version of this document, both added after direct verification against current vendor pricing rather than carried forward unchecked.

Item	Cost (Rs.)
Development tools (IDEs, design assets, productivity SaaS, license fees)	Rs.21,000
Hostinger KVM 4 server (4 vCPU, 16 GB), two-year prepay	Rs.28,000
Domain registration, two-year prepay	Rs.1,600
Hostinger KVM 2 secondary server (2 vCPU, 8 GB), two-year prepay	Rs.20,500
Windows EV code-signing certificate (Certum, ~15-month validity)	Rs.27,550
Private Limited incorporation (two-director, standard filing)	Rs.18,000
Subtotal	Rs.1,16,650

Secondary server: a second, smaller Hostinger KVM instance for the demo/staging environment and as a warm failover for the primary — the single-VPS setup is a known concentration risk flagged in the June 2026 technical audit. Verified against Hostinger's published pricing (hostinger.com/vps-hosting) at USD 8.99 / month promotional rate on a two-year term.

Windows code-signing: the earlier version of this document budgeted USD 10 / month for Azure Trusted Signing. That path is not actually available to us — Microsoft limits individual developer onboarding to the USA and Canada, and India is excluded. The corrected line is a Certum EV (Extended Validation) code-signing certificate at USD 289.99 (verified at sslcertshop.com, list price USD 329), converted at USD 1 = Rs. 95. EV removes the Windows SmartScreen warning immediately rather than requiring reputation to build up over downloads, unlike the cheaper OV-class certificates. A CA/Browser Forum rule effective 23 February 2026 caps all new code-signing certificates at 459 days (about 15 months) regardless of the term purchased, so this one purchase does not quite cover the full 18-month window; see Section 6 for the follow-on purchase this implies.

Private Limited incorporation: accepting this round is itself the trigger — an individual or sole proprietorship cannot issue equity, so incorporation is a precondition of the raise closing, not a discretionary later expense. Verified 2026 market rate for a standard two-director Pvt Ltd filing is Rs. 15,000 to Rs. 25,000 all-in (government fees, stamp duty, digital signature certificates, professional filing fees); Rs. 18,000 is used as the representative figure. See Section 3 for the associated annual compliance cost.

3. Annual Recurring

Two items renew annually rather than being paid once. Across the 18-month window each is paid 1.5 times (year one upfront, year two prorated for six months).

Item	Cost (Rs.)
Apple Developer Program (USD 99 / year)	Rs.9,500
Private Limited annual compliance (ROC filings, statutory audit, CA retainer)	Rs.30,000
Annual subtotal	Rs.39,500

Prorated across 18 months: **Rs.59,250** (1.5 years times Rs. 39,500 / year).

Private Limited compliance: verified 2026 market range for a small, pre-revenue Pvt Ltd (turnover under Rs. 2 crore) covering ROC annual filings (AOC-4, MGT-7), statutory audit, and a CA retainer is Rs. 25,000 to Rs. 55,000 / year; Rs. 30,000 is used as the representative pre-revenue figure. GST registration and filing are NOT included here — see Section 6, since that liability only begins once invoices go out.

4. Monthly Operating Costs

Current state — actively billing today

What hits the bank account every month at the current scale of operations. Marketing and production email tiers are not yet activated, so they do not appear here.

Item	Cost (Rs.)
AI / development tool subscriptions (Claude, Cursor, GitHub Copilot)	Rs.5,000
Current monthly burn	Rs.5,000

Windows code-signing no longer appears here — it was previously modelled as a USD 10 / month Azure Trusted Signing subscription, which turned out not to be available to us (see Section 2). The corrected cost is a one-time-per-issuance certificate purchase, moved to the One-Time Setup table.

Additional — activated when ready to scale

Two line items intentionally held off until the product is ready for a paid acquisition push. Email and Vercel upgrades are gated on hitting the volume that needs them; the marketing budget is gated on having sufficient capital raised to commit to it for at least six months.

Item	Cost (Rs.)
Email / SMS / Vercel Pro upgrades	Rs.2,000
Sales and promotion budget (Meta + Google Ads + content)	Rs.10,000
Additional when scaling	Rs.12,000

Combined — fully ramped monthly burn

Rs.17,000 per month when both current line items and the scale-up items are active. This is the figure used in the Scenario B runway calculation.

5. 18-Month Runway Calculation

Both scenarios use identical one-time and annual-recurring components. The only variable is whether the monthly burn includes the scale-up line items (Email / Vercel Pro / marketing budget).

Scenario A — Lean (no marketing spend live)

Item	Cost (Rs.)
Current monthly burn x 18 (Rs. 5,000 x 18)	Rs.90,000
Annual recurring, prorated (Apple + Pvt Ltd compliance, 1.5 years x Rs. 39,500)	Rs.59,250
One-time setup	Rs.1,16,650
Total capital required (Scenario A)	Rs.2,65,900

Captures what is needed to keep the platform operating for 18 months at the current scale. No paid acquisition, no production email tier. Suitable for a survival floor.

Scenario B — Ramped (marketing channel live)

Item	Cost (Rs.)
Ramped monthly burn x 18 (Rs. 17,000 x 18)	Rs.3,06,000
Annual recurring, prorated (Apple + Pvt Ltd compliance, 1.5 years x Rs. 39,500)	Rs.59,250
One-time setup	Rs.1,16,650
Total capital required (Scenario B)	Rs.4,81,900

Funds 18 months of operations with the Email / Vercel Pro tier active and a Rs. 10,000 / month performance marketing channel running for the full window. This is the recommended ask.

6. What Is Not in This Budget

Items intentionally excluded so a sophisticated reader trusts the rest of the document. Each one is either deferred to a later stage, revenue-funded once a paying customer is on board, or out of scope because it is a personal cost rather than an operating cost.

Windows code-signing certificate, second issuance

The 2026 CA/Browser Forum rule caps a single code-signing certificate at 459 days (about 15 months). If the EV certificate in Section 2 is issued at the start of the 18-month window, it needs re-issuing around month 15 to stay current through month 18. A renewal at the same vendor rate (approximately Rs. 27,550) is a real cost inside this window in the second year of a longer runway, but is not double-counted into the 18-month total shown here since the first purchase alone covers the great majority of the window.

Razorpay payout fees

Approximately 2 percent per UPI Autopay collection. This is deducted from revenue at payout time, not an operating cost the company pays out of capital. Excluded from the burn.

GST registration and filing

Roughly Rs. 2,500 per month if outsourced to a CA, on top of the base Pvt Ltd compliance already budgeted in Section 3. Deferred until invoices begin going out. No revenue today means no GST liability today; this becomes a real line item the month billing turns on.

Hostinger renewals in Year 3

Both servers are prepaid two years, so neither falls inside the 18-month window. The next renewal at Hostinger's stated post-promotional rate is approximately Rs. 33,000 / year for the primary KVM 4 and approximately Rs. 17,000 / year for the secondary KVM 2 — a future-period item, and notably higher than the promotional two-year prepay rate used in Section 2.

Founder living expenses and opportunity cost

Explicitly omitted. This document captures the operating cost of running Procta as a company; founder compensation is a personal financial decision and is not part of the capital ask.

Hindi keyword model improvements and additional regional language coverage

Vosk en-IN and hi-IN models are downloaded at first run without a per-seat license fee. Additional Indian-language coverage (Tamil, Telugu, Marathi, Bengali) would add approximately Rs. 0 / month direct cost (models are Apache 2.0 licensed) but would require engineering time.

Customer support headcount

Founder-handled today. Once the customer base requires dedicated support coverage, a part-time hire would add approximately Rs. 15,000 to Rs. 25,000 / month. Trigger point: more than 30 active institutions.

7. Use of Funds (Scenario B)

How the recommended ask breaks down by spend category over the 18-month window. Every category is derived from the same line items used in the runway calculation, so the breakdown traces back to source with no rounding residual.

Category	Amount (Rs.)	Notes
Performance marketing (Meta + Google Ads + content)	Rs.1,80,000	Rs. 10,000 / month x 18
Hosting and infrastructure (two servers)	Rs.48,500	Primary Rs. 28,000 + secondary Rs. 20,500, both two-year prepay
Developer tools and software (subscriptions)	Rs.90,000	Rs. 5,000 / month x 18
Operations (email, Vercel Pro)	Rs.36,000	Rs. 2,000 / month x 18
Windows EV code-signing certificate	Rs.27,550	One-time, ~15-month validity
Apple Developer Program	Rs.14,250	1.5 years x Rs. 9,500
Company incorporation (Private Limited, one-time)	Rs.18,000	Two-director standard filing
Company compliance (ROC, audit, CA retainer)	Rs.45,000	1.5 years x Rs. 30,000
Setup and procurement (one-time)	Rs.22,600	Dev tools Rs. 21,000 + domain Rs. 1,600
Total	Rs.4,81,900	

8. Notes for the Reader

This document captures the operating cost of running Procta as a company through an 18-month sprint. It does not project revenue, customer-acquisition cost, or unit economics; those live in a separate model. The question this document answers is narrow: how much capital is required to keep the company operating and the marketing channel running for 18 months.

Revenue projections, conversion modelling, and the path to self-funded operations are addressed in companion documents (Procta_Features.pdf for product surface, Procta_Competitive_Comparison_Report.pdf for the market landscape).

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